



India Partners with WHO to Mainstream Ayush Globally through a Landmark Agreement on Traditional Medicine Interventions

This initiative will help in making Ayush reach maximum number of people across the world in a scientific manner: Prime Minister

Posted On: 25 MAY 2025 6:05PM by PIB Delhi

In a landmark development poised to transform the global standing of traditional medicine systems, an agreement was signed between the Ministry of Ayush and the World Health Organization (WHO) on May 24, 2025. The agreement marks the beginning of work on a dedicated Traditional Medicine module under the International Classification of Health Interventions (ICHI).

Highlighting the significance of this achievement during the 122nd episode of Mann Ki Baat, Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi said: *"Friends, something has happened in the field of Ayurveda as well, which you will be very happy to know about. Just yesterday, i.e. on 24th May, an MoU was signed in the presence of WHO Director General and my friend Tulsi Bhai. Along with this agreement, work has started on a dedicated traditional medicine module under the International Classification of Health Interventions. This initiative will help in making Ayush reach maximum number of people across the world in a scientific manner."*

The ICHI, complementing WHO's International Classification of Diseases (ICD-11), documents what treatments and health interventions are administered. With the inclusion of a traditional medicine module, therapies from Ayurveda, Yoga, Siddha, and Unani systems—such as Panchakarma, Yoga therapy, Unani regimens, and Siddha procedures—will now be recognized in globally standardized terms.

This will bring about multiple benefits:

- Transparent billing and fair pricing for Ayush services.
- Smoother integration of Ayush treatments in health insurance coverage.
- Enhanced hospital management, clinical documentation, and health research.
- Most importantly, greater global accessibility to Ayush interventions.

This development aligns with India's vision of bringing its rich heritage of traditional wisdom into the global healthcare mainstream, backed by scientific classification and international standards.

Welcoming the agreement, WHO Director-General Dr. Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus stated on X (formerly Twitter):

"Pleased to sign an agreement for a \$3 million contribution from #India to @WHO's work on traditional medicine and the International Classification of Health Interventions, with @moAyush Secretary Vaidya Rajesh Kotecha. We welcome IN's continued commitment to #HealthForAll."

The combined impact of ICD-11 for diseases and the new ICHI module for interventions will ensure that Ayush becomes an integral, evidence-based, and policy-recognized part of global healthcare systems.

This is more than a coding update—it is a transformative step toward affordable, accessible, and trusted healthcare through India's traditional systems.

MV/AKS

(Release ID: 2131164) Visitor Counter : 55

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